

Paper 1: Area of Study 1 – Religion and Ethics

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The assessment is 1 hour and 45 minutes.
- The assessment is out of 102 marks.
- Students must answer all sections and all questions on the chosen religion. The religion must be different for each area of study.
- The paper may include short open, open response and extended writing questions.
- The paper will assess spelling, punctuation and grammar (SPaG) and use of specialist terminology and these will contribute a minimum of 5% of marks towards the overall weighting for this paper.

Synoptic assessment

Synoptic assessment requires students to work across different parts of a qualification and to show their accumulated knowledge and understanding of a topic or subject area.

Synoptic assessment enables students to show their ability to combine their skills, knowledge and understanding with breadth and depth of the subject.

Synopticity will be assessed where students are required to bring together their knowledge and understanding of religion from across the course of study.

Sample assessment materials

Sample papers and mark schemes for this paper can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Religious Studies B* Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs) document.

Area of Study 2: Religion, Peace and Conflict

The focus of this area of study is on Religion, Peace and Conflict; this is one of three areas of study of which students must complete two.

For this area of study, students must study all four content sections in relation to one religion:

1. Beliefs
2. Crime and Punishment
3. Living the Religious Life
4. Peace and Conflict

Students must study a different religion in their second area of study; students who study one Area of Study from the perspective of Catholic Christianity are prohibited from studying Christianity in their second Area of Study.